

DIGITAL MARKETING · MONTHLY REPORT

# Sydney Masonic Centre

## June 2026 Report

A deliberate efficiency month on about a third of the usual budget: the funnel rebuilt, a converting landing page live, Meta ready to launch and SEO compounding — the groundwork set to pay off as the budget returns through the second half.

| REPORTING PERIOD | CLIENT                | CHANNELS                  | PREPARED BY   |
|------------------|-----------------------|---------------------------|---------------|
| June 2026        | Sydney Masonic Centre | Google · Meta · SEO · Web | Pixel Anxiety |

### 01 Overview

The month the funnel started working — and we could finally prove it.

June was a breakthrough on the thing we can control right now: measuring properly. The campaign had been sending paid traffic to a gallery page with **no enquiry form** in June we rebuilt conversion tracking and, right at month-end, took the new venue-hire landing page live. The rebuilt tracking is the win: it now captures **23 genuine form enquiries** for the period where Google's native form-submit tracking was seeing just four — so for the first time we're counting real leads accurately. The new landing page and redesigned form only just went live, so their lift on conversion is still ahead of us — that's July's story.

On efficiency, the ads worked harder per dollar. On roughly a third of May's budget, cost per lead came in around **\$166 — below May's \$236 and April's \$201** — and cost per click fell to \$1.76 from \$2.33, roughly a third more clicks for every dollar. Cost per lead is still higher than we ultimately want — and the biggest lever isn't clicks, it's completion: on the old page the enquiry form was buried and hard to reach, and around 96 people who started an enquiry in June didn't finish it. The new landing page and redesigned form target exactly that gap, and lifting completion is what takes cost per lead a lot lower on the same spend. On the organic side, SEO continues to build: organic search rebounded **+24% from April to May** to its strongest level in months and now drives **37% of all traffic as the most engaged audience on the site**. Year on year, form leads are up 77% and lead value up 90%.

The web foundation laid over recent months — PHP 8.2, LiteSpeed caching, database clean-up, Yoast SEO and 22 rewritten meta descriptions — is what makes this compound. We head into July positioned to scale: restore the Google budget onto a page that now converts, switch Meta on, and keep the organic curve climbing.

23

FORM ENQUIRIES

\$166

▼ vs \$236 May  
COST / LEAD

\$1.76

▼ vs \$2.33 May  
COST / CLICK

+77%

YoY  
FORM LEADS

37%

most engaged  
ORGANIC TRAFFIC

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## Progress Pillars

Where each workflow stands at the end of June. ► **Highlighted items** are new or advanced this month.

#### CONTENT

- 120+ high-quality images shot, edited and processed for SMC
- Full edit & post-processing on every image (colour, crop, retouch)
- GIF and MP4 assets exported for flexible use
- Organised for reuse across landing pages, ads and the website
- **Imagery now feeding the live landing page and search/Meta asset sets**

#### WEBSITE

- Upgraded to PHP 8.2 for security & performance
- WordPress extensions validated under 8.2
- LiteSpeed caching configured (browser, object, minification)
- Database cleaned from ~3,112 items to ~30
- Lighthouse scores improved — reduced LCP, better TTFB
- **Ongoing speed & Core Web Vitals optimisation continuing**

#### META

- New Meta advertising account created, configured & verified
- Campaign structure set up with a lead-generation focus
- Audience & targeting mapped for initial campaigns
- Conversion tracking aligned with the website pixel / GTM
- **Lead-gen forms created**
- **New ads built — go live July**
- **Traffic to route to the new landing page**

#### LANDING PAGE

- Built in Elementor for flexible, easy ongoing edits
- Dedicated lead-capture form built into the page
- Clear call-to-action and hero section to drive enquiries
- Clean, single conversion point to measure ad performance
- **V1 live — now the destination for all paid clicks**
- Sector-specific pages (weddings, conferences, corporate) in design

#### GOOGLE

- Verified in Search Console; sitemap submitted for full crawling
- GTM setup and conversion pixel checked
- Meta descriptions written for 22 pages to lift click-through
- Monitoring search terms, indexing and pages driving traffic
- **Ads re-pointed to the enquiry landing page**
- Final URL expansion turned off — wasted spend closed
- **6 intended search themes added; conversion tracking verified**
- **Volume dip diagnosed to budget; recovery plan set**

#### MARKETING HUB

- Hub live and accessible online — single source of truth
- Central hub housing campaigns, assets and reporting in one place
- Dashboard 2.0 underway, with v1 now live
- Kanban board in development to track work & progress
- Calendar added for scheduling and visibility
- **Go-Gets section being built out; foundation set for more tools**

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## Analysis & Performance

### 02 Google Ads — campaign performance

The active Performance Max campaign for June, run on a temporarily reduced budget — about a third of May's — while the structural fixes shipped. Full budget returns as the converting page and Meta come online.

IMPRESSIONS  
**112,010**  
▲ 410k impressions per \$ vs May

CLICKS  
**2,172**  
▲ +32k clicks per \$ vs May

ENQUIRIES  
**23**  
Form enquiries

SPEND  
**\$3,825**  
% of May

COST / LEAD  
**\$166**  
▼ from \$236 May

AVG. CPC  
**\$1.76**  
▼ from \$2.33 May

CTR  
**1.94%**  
Up on May's 1.60%

OPTIMISATION  
**79.5%**  
Headroom identified

Our focus in June was not to chase volume, but to fix what happens after the click. With the budget deliberately trimmed to about a third of May's, we still cut cost per click and cost per lead — the ads are working harder per dollar. With the landing page now live and Meta about to switch on, restoring budget from here should convert into materially stronger lead volume.

**The headline isn't volume, it's efficiency.** We cut spend to about **40% of May's** budget, yet still generated **23 leads — 57% of May's 40**. That works out to roughly **45% more leads for every dollar spent**, with cost per lead down 30% (\$236 → \$166) and more impressions per dollar too. And every paid click now lands on a page built to convert. When budget scales back onto that page, this is the base it compounds from.

### 03 Google Ads — recent trend

The last three months, June ran on about a third of the budget, yet efficiency — cost per click and per lead — moved the right way.

| METRIC      | APR     | MAY     | JUN     |
|-------------|---------|---------|---------|
| Impressions | 277,777 | 257,884 | 112,010 |
| Ad spend    | \$9,654 | \$9,661 | \$3,825 |
| Clicks      | 3,621   | 4,141   | 2,172   |
| Enquiries   | 48      | 40      | 23      |
| Avg. CPC    | \$2.00  | \$2.33  | \$1.76  |
| Cost / lead | \$201   | \$236   | \$166   |

June ran on about a third of May's budget, so reach is lower by design — but the ads worked harder per dollar: roughly a third more clicks per dollar, cost per lead down to \$166 (from \$236), CPC to \$1.76 (from \$2.33), and click-through up to 1.94% (from ~1.6%). Enquiries reflect our custom "enquiry submitted" tracking (23 for the month).

### 04 12-month lead review

Leads, spend and cost-per-lead by month — trailing twelve months to June 2026.

| MONTH    | LEADS | COST    | LEAD COST | MONTH        | LEADS | COST     | LEAD COST |
|----------|-------|---------|-----------|--------------|-------|----------|-----------|
| Jul 2025 | 78    | \$7,821 | \$100.28  | Jan 2026     | 21    | \$2,791  | \$132.94  |
| Aug 2025 | 70    | \$5,811 | \$83.02   | Feb 2026     | 50    | \$6,050  | \$121.01  |
| Sep 2025 | 65    | \$6,395 | \$97.65   | Mar 2026     | 52    | \$8,304  | \$159.71  |
| Oct 2025 | 48    | \$5,739 | \$118.35  | Apr 2026     | 48    | \$9,654  | \$200.99  |
| Nov 2025 | 26    | \$6,550 | \$251.92  | May 2026     | 40    | \$9,661  | \$235.86  |
| Dec 2025 | 30    | \$3,331 | \$111.06  | Jun 2026     | 23    | \$3,825  | \$166.30  |
|          |       |         |           | 12-mth total | 551   | \$75,932 | \$137.81  |

### 05 SEO, website & organic search

Organic is quietly becoming the strongest channel — and the most engaged.

**Organic is compounding because of work done over the past few months, not overnight.** Starting from a site that had **no SEO plugin at all**, we configured Yoast end to end, rewrite 22 meta descriptions, verified Search Console and submitted the sitemap, and shipped the technical foundation — PHP 8.2, LiteSpeed caching and a database clean-up — that makes pages fast enough to rank. The payoff is showing: organic search rebounded **+24% from April to May** (1,686 → 2,092 sessions), now drives **37% of all site traffic**, and organic visitors are the **most engaged audience on the site** (engagement near 59%, well above the 46–51% site-wide) — high-intent traffic at zero click cost. This is the channel that keeps paying back long after the work is done.

ORGANIC SHARE OF TRAFFIC  
**37%**  
of all site visits

ORGANIC ENGAGEMENT RATE  
**59%**  
the most engaged audience

ORGANIC GROWTH  
APR → MAY  
**+24%**  
window high · 2,092 sessions

SITE ENGAGEMENT  
· JUNE  
**52.4%**  
up from 46.5% in May

BOUNCE RATE  
· JUNE  
**47.7%**  
down from 53.5% in May

SESSIONS · JUNE  
**3,996**  
on ~1% of the paid budget

META DESCRIPTIONS REWRITTEN  
**22**  
for search visibility

SEO FOUNDATION  
**Yoast live**  
the site had no SEO plugin before

Calendar-June GA4 (live SMC Marketing Dashboard): 3,996 sessions · 2,986 users · **52.4% engagement rate** · 2,092 engaged sessions — engagement up on May's site-wide 46.5% and bounce down to 47.7%, even as total sessions eased with the lower paid budget.

### 06 Lead tracking — by financial year

Two financial years compared (AU FY: 1 Jul – 30 Jun). Four lead types tracked across all activity — last year versus this year.

| LEAD TYPE      | FY 2024–25 | FY 2025–26 | CHANGE  |
|----------------|------------|------------|---------|
| Form leads     | 250        | 443        | ▲ +77%  |
| Phone leads    | 512        | 138        | ▼       |
| Contacts       | 118        | 191        | ▲ +62%  |
| Get directions | 1,891      | 6,937      | ▲ +267% |
| Page views     | 327        | 1,278      | ▲ +291% |

► "Phone-call tracking is misconfigured. Calls are meant to record through the Google Ads 'Calls from ads' conversion, but that action is currently flagged misconfigured and under-recording — it logged zero conversions in June even though 14 people clicked to call. So the year-on-year phone figure above understates reality and the change can't be trusted yet — that's why it's marked with an asterisk rather than a drop. We're fixing the call conversion and adding phone back into the campaign's bidding goal. (Separately, the dashboard's "phone clicks" tile is a GA4 wiring gap, also queued in Next Steps.)

| FUNNEL STEP                               | JUNE  |
|-------------------------------------------|-------|
| Form starts — people who began an enquiry | 119   |
| Completed form enquiries                  | 23    |
| Started but didn't finish                 | ≈96   |
| Clicks-to-call — June (tracked, active)   | 14    |
| Phone-call conversions — June*            | 0     |
| Get-directions — organic intent (FY)      | 6,937 |

| ENQUIRY FORMS          | CLICKS-TO-CALL               | PHONE-CALL CONVERSIONS             | TOTAL LEADS<br>· ALL SOURCES               | COST / LEAD<br>· ALL IN      |
|------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| <b>23</b><br>completed | <b>14</b><br>active tracking | <b>0</b><br>tracking misconfigured | <b>37</b><br>forms + calls + click-to-call | <b>\$103</b><br>\$3,825 ÷ 37 |

► Counting every lead signal — 23 form enquiries, 14 click-to-call and 0 recorded phone-call conversions (tracking misconfigured, being fixed) — June produced 37 leads at \$103 each. The \$166 earlier is cost per form enquiry only; \$103 is the blended cost once calls and click-to-call are counted. Fixing the call conversion makes this both more accurate and lower.

#### The biggest single opportunity in the account

**119 people started an enquiry in June — only 23 finished.** That's a gap of roughly 96 would-be leads walking away mid-form. The old form sat on a heavy WPBakery page that was slow and awkward on mobile. The **new Elementor landing page and redesigned enquiry form** — shorter, clearer, mobile-first — went live at month-end specifically to close this gap. If the new form lifts completion even modestly, lead volume climbs — and cost per lead drops with it — **at zero extra ad spend**. This is the big lever for July.

► Our custom "enquiry submitted" event captured all 23 enquiries where GA4's native form-submit tracking saw only 4 — the rebuilt tracking is far more complete. Both enquiry forms are counted in Google Ads: "Lead from pages other than contact us" (113) plus "Contact Us Page Lead" (6) — the 21 form conversions Google credits. A tracking clean-up is queued — several conversion actions currently flag as "misconfigured" in the account.

### 07 What we delivered — Google

The Google Ads work completed under this month's retainer.

- A Pointed the ads at the enquiry page**  
All paid traffic now lands on the dedicated venue-hire "Get Started" page — hero, value proposition and a full enquiry form — instead of a generic listing with no call-to-action.  
**Live**
- B Stopped wasted spend**  
Turned off Final URL expansion, which had let Google send clicks to whichever page it chose — including a leftover template URL drawing tens of thousands of impressions at 0.09% CTR. Traffic is now consolidated on the page that converts.  
**Fixed**
- C Sharpened targeting**  
Added six intent-led search themes — venue hire Sydney, function venue Sydney CBD, conference venue Sydney, wedding venue Sydney, corporate event venue Sydney and gala dinner venue Sydney.  
**Added**
- D Verified conversion tracking**  
Confirmed both form submissions and phone-call leads are recording correctly, so the campaign optimises on real enquiries.  
**Confirmed**
- E Diagnosed the volume dip**  
Traced the softening in reach to daily-budget reductions. Performance Max spends to its budget — restoring it is the recovery lever now that clicks land on a converting page.  
**Diagnosed**

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## Landing Page

### 08 The new venue-hire page — live

Built in Elementor, purpose-built to convert paid traffic into enquiries. Now the destination for every Google click.

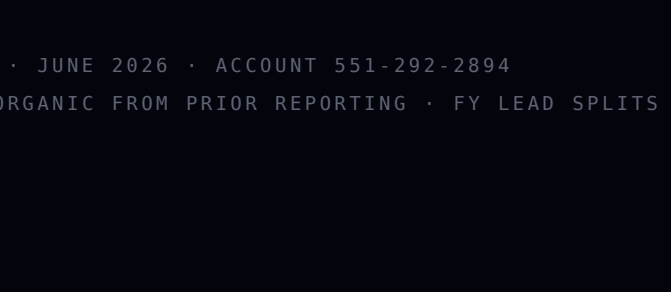
**Hero & value proposition** — "Sydney's most iconic venue for hire" with a single clear Get Started call-to-action, immediately framing the offer for arriving visitors.

**Iconic spaces** — Grand Lodge, Banquet Hall and Marble Foyer showcased with real photography and short, benefit-led descriptions.

**Why SMC** — prime CBD location, 155+ years, full AV & production, premium catering — the credibility signals that move an enquiry.

**Full enquiry form** — name, company, contact, guest numbers, dates, budget, event type and requirements — a clean, single conversion point wired to tracking.

► Sector-specific landing pages (Weddings, Conferences, Corporate & Galas) are in design — each will match a dedicated ad set for tighter intent and higher conversion.



### 09 Completed in June — across channels

Beyond the Google work above, here's what shipped this month across the rest of the program.

| WEBSITE & SPEED                                                                              | META                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ► Continued LiteSpeed & QUIC.cloud CDN speed optimisation, building on May's PHP 8.2 upgrade | ► <b>Lead-gen forms created</b> in-platform                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| ► Ongoing Core Web Vitals work — reduced LCP, improved TTFB, WebP delivery                   | ► <b>New ads built and verified</b> — go live July                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| ► Database kept lean (~30 items) for faster admin and page loads                             | ► Audience & targeting mapped; tracking aligned with pixel / GTM                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| LANDING PAGE                                                                                 | MARKETING HUB                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| ► <b>V1 live</b> in Elementor — hero, clear CTA and full enquiry form                        | ► Hub live as the single source of truth for campaigns, assets & reporting                                                                                                                                                                          |
| ► Now the single destination for every paid click                                            | ► Dashboard 2.0 — v1 now live                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| ► Clean conversion point to measure ad performance and lift Quality Score                    | ► Kanban board, Go-Gets and Calendar in build-out                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| ► Sector pages (weddings, conferences, corporate) in design                                  | <b>GOOGLE (RECAP)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| CONTENT                                                                                      | ► Ads re-pointed to enquiry page · URL expansion off · 6 search themes added                                                                                                                                                                        |
| ► 120+ image & GIF library now feeding the live landing page and ad sets                     | ► Conversion tracking verified · budget dip diagnosed — full detail in section 07                                                                                                                                                                   |
| ► Food & venue photography in active use across channels                                     | <b>OTHER</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|                                                                                              | ► Online PDF download · additional Google integrations · sitemap review                                                                                                                                                                             |
|                                                                                              | ► <b>Fix conversion tracking</b> — several actions (both lead forms, "Calls from ads" the enquiry event) flag as "misconfigured"; fix the call conversion so phone records, bring call & phone into bidding, and wire phone into the dashboard file |
|                                                                                              | ► Authorise Porter Metrics to pull Meta into the reporting dashboard                                                                                                                                                                                |
|                                                                                              | ► Build per-form enquiry breakdown once the GA4 source dimension lands                                                                                                                                                                              |

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## Marketing Hub

### 10 One place for everything

The SMC Marketing Hub is live — a private intranet housing campaigns, assets, analytics and planning in a single source of truth. A new **live reporting dashboard** — auto-refreshing and branded — now sits alongside it, pulling GA4 and Google Ads into one always-current view.

**ANALYTICS**  
► Google Analytics 4 report built in — sessions, engagement and conversions in one view

**SMC x Pixel Anxiety Intranet: Home · Analytics · Go-Gets Assets · Calendar & Tools**

**ASSETS**  
► Videos & images library, campaign creative and brand files, organised for reuse

**Dashboard 2.0 · v1 live**

**GO-GETS**  
► "What's Going On", "Let's Talk" and Dynamic Gadgets — hot links and weekly gadgets to keep work moving

**CALENDAR & TOOLS**  
► Scheduling, visibility and the foundation for ongoing build-out.

► Open the SMC Marketing Hub

### 11 Next steps & work in progress

What's queued for July and beyond, by workflow.

| MAJOR                                                                               | SEO                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ► <b>Restore the Google budget</b> onto a page that now converts                    | ► Monitor Search Console for terms driving traffic and indexing                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| ► <b>Meta ads go live</b> (July) with lead-gen forms                                | ► Consider Yoast SEO Premium for AI meta, redirects and schema                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| ► <b>Venue photoshoot — booking now</b> — capture spaces & live events              | ► Enable the LiteSpeed crawler to pre-warm cache                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| ► <b>Refresh landing-page</b> and ad imagery and feed the new sector pages          | ► Increase OPcache memory 128MB → 256MB for faster loads                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| ► <b>Lead automation with CRM</b> — auto-route & nurture every enquiry on submit    | <b>OTHER</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| ► Ship sector landing pages — weddings, conferences, corporate                      | ► Online PDF download · additional Google integrations · sitemap review                                                                                                                                                                             |
| ► Add video assets to lift ad strength to "Excellent"                               | ► <b>Fix conversion tracking</b> — several actions (both lead forms, "Calls from ads" the enquiry event) flag as "misconfigured"; fix the call conversion so phone records, bring call & phone into bidding, and wire phone into the dashboard file |
| <b>MARKETING HUB BUILD-OUT</b>                                                      | ► Authorise Porter Metrics to pull Meta into the reporting dashboard                                                                                                                                                                                |
| ► <b>Marketing Hub 2.0</b> — next version to go live                                | ► Build per-form enquiry breakdown once the GA4 source dimension lands                                                                                                                                                                              |
| ► <b>New reporting dashboard</b> go live (Dashboard 2.0, branded & auto-refreshing) |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| ► Kanban Board · Go-Gets · Calendar                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |